MCP

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The Leak

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By Gavin Barker

Characters:

BERT SUMMERS: A very excited middle aged man who took his friend Hank fishing in a canoe he just bought from a yard sale.

HANK MORRIS: A middle aged man who was dragged on a fishing trip by his annoying friend.

Setting:

2021 in the Middle of the Great Bottleman Lake in Canntown, USA.

(The play opens on two men sitting on either end of a canoe holding fishing poles. The first man, BERT, should look very happy, while the second man, HANK should look unimpressed)

BERT:

You know I'm glad we got to do this. I haven't had a chance to get out on the water in months!

HANK:

Yep, Sure has been a little while.

BERT:

Right? *(beat)* I can't believe I got such a good deal on this canoe, I mean $15!

HANK:

I wouldn't call it a deal; this thing has definitely seen better days. It kind of looks like this thing is rotting.

BERT:

You have to admit this is nice though. It's so peaceful out here! We're just sitting out on the water, poles on our backs, wet feet..

HANK:

I guess it's- *(beat)* did you say wet feet?

(Hank looks down and sees that water is filling the canoe)

HANK:

BERT! WE'RE LEAKING!!

BERT:

Huh?.. Holy Mackerel!

HANK:

Well don’t just sit there you oaf!! Grab a paddle!!

BERT:

Oh my God! Tthis is so exciting!!

(Bert and Hank grab a paddle each from in the boat and begin to paddle)

HANK:

This is not freaking exciting– why would you think this is exciting?!

BERT:

Oh come on Hank, It’s not that bad. It’s just a little water!

HANK:

BERT!! It is not the time, just help me paddle this frickin’ boat!

BERT:

Alright, alright don’t get your swordfish in a knot.

HANK:

Paddle, you salmon head!!

BERT:

I am, I am!!

HANK:

Not that way you idiot! You’re turning us around!

BERT:

Ha ha, I haven't had this much fun since band camp!..

HANK:

Bert you half wit, you're making it worse!!

BERT:

..All those blowable instruments!

HANK:

BERT!!

BERT:

Huh?

HANK:

Will you please just pay attention to what you're doing!

BERT:

Oh, right sorry I'm just having a really nice time.

HANK:

*(Angry)*Well, I'm really happy! *(beat)* I never should came on this dumb fishing trip, but you just wouldn't leave me alone about it, because you think it's just so darn exciting!!

BERT:

You think this trip is dumb?

HANK:

Yes, Bert I do! I didn't even want to come in the first place, but that's all you've been talking about for the last three and a half weeks! I mean give it rest for God's sake man!

BERT:

...Oh I didn't realize you felt like that.

(Bert stops paddling)

HANK:

What the heck are you doing? *(beat)* Bert don't stop paddling!

BERT:

Why didn't you just say you didn't want to come on the trip with me?

HANK:

Bert whenever we get back to land we can have a long talk about it, but I need you to paddle!

(Bert still doesn't paddle)

HANK:

Bert we're taking on a lot of water here, and if you don't start paddling I swear to god I will shove this ore so far up-!

BERT:

I thought you were just as excited as I was about the trip.

HANK:

Bert, please just help me!

BERT:

I mean we never get to hang out anymore. We used to be buddies, we were inseparable!

HANK:

We're gonna have to plug this hole with something!

BERT:

But Ha-

HANK:

I'll find something to stick in the hole, you're gonna have to get some of this water out!

BERT:

Oh alright! *(beat)* Well do you have a bucket?

HANK:

No, I don't have a bucket! J- Just use your hat or something!

BERT:

My hat?

HANK:

Just do it!!

BERT:

Fine, fine but you owe me a new hat. OH, WE CAN GO SHOPPING!

HANK:

Whatever, just hurry up! I'll just uhh *(looks around nervously)* Ah ha!

(Hank pulls off his gloves and quickly begins trying to shove them in the hole, while Bert frantically bails out water using his hat)

HANK:

Almooost… HA! GOT IT!!

BERT:

I don't think that's going to hold very long.

HANK:

Yeah I know! Are you still bailing?!

BERT:

Nope all done! *(leans back and plops his soaking hat back on his head) Well done, me!*

HANK:

Stop lying there you numbskull, we still gotta paddle!!

BERT:

Oh come on, are you scared to get wet? *(Splashes Hank)*

HANK:

Quit freaking splashing me!!

BERT:

Oh, lighten up a little Hank!!

HANK:

Dammit Bert! I can't swim!!

BERT:

(beat) What?!

HANK:

I can't swim! I never learned how, so can you please just drop it and help me with paddling this Gosh dang Boat!!

BERT:

Well, why didn't you just tell me you couldn't swim? I mean it's a little embarrassing, but it's not that big a deal, we could've done something else like go camping.. or throw eggs at cars!!

HANK:

(Swings arm and points) BERT! Do you see that right there?! That thing is called a paddle and you use it to move canoes, so how about you pick the darn thing up, AND USE IT BEFORE I DROWN!!

(Bert pauses for a second, looking a little hurt before picking up the oar and begins rowing)

HANK:

(Sighs) Finally. *(beat)* Do you have any idea how frustrating you are? You're really going to have to speed up. We don't have that long until we're at eye level with the fish!

BERT:

I may be frustrating but at least I know how to swim.

HANK:

Just hurry and shut up, we're getting close.

BERT:

Don't tell me to shut up, all I wanted to do was hang out with my best friend!

HANK:

For the love of- Bert you and I are not, nor will we ever be *best friends*! We never have been. All you are is that annoying guy from highschool that would never leave me the hell alone!! Why can't you just leave me ALONE!!

(Bert is silent for a moment, and then gets a really stern look on his face)

BERT:

Ok.

(Bert stops paddling)

HANK:

What are you doing!? Are you stupid? I'll drown!!

BERT:

Oh well.

HANK:

Listen here you oaf, help me or I swear to god I will drag you to the bottom of this lake!!

BERT:

Go on then. I want you to, I want you to pull me down kicking and screaming!

HANK:

Yo- YOU- gahh! What is wrong with you! You freaking idiot, row the dang boat!!

BERT:

No. You're going to sit here and sink to the bottom of this lake. *(beat)* and I'm going to sit here and watch.

HANK:

The hell I am! When I get this boat to land we're done, I never want to see or hear from you again!!

(Hank begins to frantically row)

BERT:

This boat is not going to make it to land anyway, we're too far out. *(beat)* Looks like you're stuck out here.

HANK:

Why did you even want to go fishing in the first place, you freaking psycho?!

BERT:

I just wanted to go on a fun trip with my friend.

HANK:

I should have never come with you. I should have ignored you in high school. I should have told you to get away from me and go bother someone else!

BERT:

You should've learned how to swim.

HANK:

You're nothing but a slimy idiot! There's a reason no one spoke to you in high school, and why you're a lonely man with no one in your life but me!!

BERT:

Well, at least I'll make it back home, and never have to listen to another insult come crawling out of your mouth, you selfish piece of crap!

HANK:

Yeah you might make it home, but what then? You're just going to spend the rest of your sad pathetic life alone, with no friends, no family, and no purpose in this world!

BERT:

Shut up..

HANK:

You'll have nobody! Hell, you don't have anybody! I was the only person you had in your miserable life and I didn't even want to hang out with you!!

BERT:

Hank..

HANK:

That is the most pathetic thing-

BERT:

STOP! Just shut up, shut up, shut up!!

HANK:

WHY!! Because I'm right!? *(long Beat)* ..Yeah that's what it is right?

BERT:

Hank..stop.

HANK:

Or what Bert? What are you going to do, *yell, scream,* or maybe you just sit there and complain?

BERT:

GAHH!!

(Bert takes his oar and hits it over Hank's head, Hank falls back in the canoe limp)

BERT:

(long beat) Hank?

(silence)

BERT:

Hank?! *(Shakes Hank)* Hank wake up!

(Hank doesn't move as a look of fear comes over Bert's face)

BERT:

Oh god.. Hank, I'm so sorry! I didn't mean it I swear, please forgive me!

(*Bert sits in silence as the canoe sinks looking at Hank)*

BERT:

I shouldn't have made you come with me on this trip, I just wanted us to hang out again. I'm sorry I forced you to be my friend, you were just the only person who ever talked to me. *(beat)* You're right I am alone.

(Bert stares at Hank)

BERT:

Oh god what have I done!? *(Bert straightens up Hank so he's back in a sitting position)* It's alright Hank I- I -I'm not going to leave you. I'll stay here with you I promise. *(Bert sits with Hank. The sound of water gurgling and sloshing into the canoe grows louder as the canoe sinks, enveloping both Hank and Bert.*

The lights fade to black)

End of Play